David Gareth Werren (Known as Gareth)

Chief Platform Officer | Lending & Fintech Software Platforms | AI-Enabled Engineering

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Summary

Technology leader and software architect with 19 years' experience, 17 of them in financial services, currently Chief Platform Officer at Fignum. I lead the architecture, engineering and AI strategy for Origin and Adapt, Fignum's loan origination and servicing platforms for specialist lenders, working closely with clients from pre-sales through to delivery.

Having built and led a team of around 30 across the UK, Portugal and Hungary, I combine hands-on AI adoption in a regulated environment with a track record of winning board support through clear, evidence-based proposals.

Key Achievements

Board-level influence: Persuaded the Bluestone Group board to invest in building a new origination platform instead of enhancing the existing home-grown system, modelling and presenting cost, timeline and risk for each option side by side. That platform is now Origin, Fignum's flagship product, live with mortgage and motor lenders.

Shared platform architecture: Architected Evolve, the core platform that powers both loan origination (Origin) and loan servicing (Adapt). Evolve underpins our rapid prototyping and delivery of bespoke client solutions.

AI transformation: Led the adoption of Claude Code and GitHub Copilot through a champions network, showcases and dedicated experimentation time. Built team-wide AI tooling including internal MCP servers and shared skill definitions and knowledge. We estimate a 2x to 10x increase in delivery capacity, depending on the type of task, whilst maintaining quality.

AI-powered client prototyping: Introduced rapid prototyping sessions for prospective clients and new implementations. They have become a strong pre-sales tool and cut new implementation requirements gathering to around a week while significantly improving quality.

Team leadership: Built and led a team of teams of around 30 engineers and testers across the UK, Portugal and Hungary, including two outsourced partners, delivering multi-million-pound programmes while supporting existing systems.

Skills

Leadership and strategy: Board and CEO stakeholder management • Distributed teams • Vendor and partner management • Pre-sales and RFPs

Architecture and engineering: Software architecture • Engineering standards and CI/CD

AI: AI strategy and adoption • Claude Code • GitHub Copilot • MCP • In-product agentic AI

Technology: C# • SQL • Distributed systems • Kafka • Kubernetes • Azure DevOps • GitHub

Financial services: Lending (mortgage and motor) • Pensions • Trading and risk

Experience

Chief Platform Officer (2025 – Current), Head of Development (2020 – 2025), Fignum, Cambridge

Fignum is a fintech startup within the Bluestone Group, providing highly configurable loan origination and servicing platforms to specialist lenders. Reporting to the CEO, I'm accountable for the software platform, architecture, engineering, delivery and AI strategy.

Platform and Product

- Architected Evolve, the shared platform underpinning two products:
    - Origin: A configurable loan origination system for multi-asset lending including mortgage and motor, with 30+ third-party integrations. Live with mortgage and motor clients, with a multi-asset client in progress.
    - Adapt: A configurable loan servicing system with a double-entry finance engine, collections workflow system and bank reconciliation. First client under way.
- Architected Paycada, an SME payments platform integrating with Xero and Stripe, sharing many components from the Evolve platform.
- Defined AI product capabilities within Origin and Adapt, combining the best of build (full in-product agentic capabilities) and buy (e.g. bank statement data extraction) solutions.

Clients and Commercial

- Led technical pre-sales demos and RFP responses.
- Introduced AI-powered rapid prototyping sessions with prospective clients as a powerful new pre-sales tool.
- Owned budgets for major client and platform projects.

AI-Enabled Engineering

- Led adoption of AI across the software delivery lifecycle. Claude Code for development, test generation and documentation. GitHub Copilot for PR review. Custom tooling including MCP servers and monitoring and triage tools.
- Drove adoption through a champions network, AI showcase sessions across the wider business, shared custom tooling, and dedicated experimentation time

Team, Standards and Operations

- Built and led a team of teams across Evolve, Paycada and existing production systems, totalling around 30 engineers and testers across the UK, Portugal and Hungary.
- Set engineering standards and CI/CD practices, allowing the team to release changes quickly and confidently.
- Worked with IT and Compliance on Fignum's obligations as an FCA material supplier, including security, resilience and operational compliance.
- Managed a suite of legacy in-house products including card payments and telephony systems, focusing on service quality, compliance and support.

Lead Developer, River and Mercantile Solutions, London 2014 – 2020

River and Mercantile Solutions (now Schroders Solutions) provided fiduciary and advisory services to pension funds.

- Provided technical leadership across the team of 9 in-house developers alongside leading the implementation of automated build, test and deployment solutions
- Designed and built trade modelling systems for securities and currency hedging, with complex user interfaces
- Designed and built an online portal for clients to access up-to-date scheme information and as a platform for our consultants to use in client meetings

Software Engineer, Base 4, Cambridge 2012 – 2014

Base 4 was a small biotech company developing brand new systems for DNA sequencing.

- Designed and built high-performance lab control and data capture systems, reducing the time taken to run experiments from days to hours and increasing the quality of data captured
- Designed and built data analysis software to reduce and streamline manual effort

Software Developer, SunGard Adaptiv, Cambridge 2007 – 2012

SunGard's Adaptiv (now part of FIS) provided market and credit risk solutions to the financial sector.

- Grew from building the initial POC for a brand-new enterprise product (Adaptiv Risk Cube) to being the lead architect, leading client POCs and implementations, and managing a team

Education 2001 - 2005

University of Bristol: Master of Engineering (Joint Honours: Computer Science, Electrical Engineering, Engineering Maths)